GADE MAHESWARREDDY

Network Engineer

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Summary:

- Network engineering professional with over 5+ years of experience in network design, implementation, troubleshooting and management of large-scale enterprise networks.
- Extensive work experience with Cisco Routers, Cisco Switches, Load Balancers and Firewalls.
- working in enterprise networking, mostly in Cisco heavy environments and AWS backed setups, with a focus on keeping Layer 2 and Layer 3 predictable.
- Tend to live near the routing table, spending a lot of time with OSPF, BGP, and EIGRP so paths, failover, and redistribution stay understandable and debug gable.
- Usually end up cleaning up Layer 2, aligning VLAN layouts, trunks, and STP/RSTP behavior so broadcast domains are sensible and loops or odd floods do not surprise anyone.
- Comfortable around Catalyst, Nexus, and ASR 9000 gear, treating hardware differences as constraints to work with rather than excuses when doing upgrades or migrations.
- Have a habit of reaching for packet captures and flow data early, using Wireshark and monitoring tools like SolarWinds NPM and Grafana instead of guessing about latency or drops.
- Think in terms of repeatable changes, using Ansible and Terraform for routing, firewall, and AWS VPC builds so common patterns become templates instead of one off edits.
- On the security side, stay pragmatic, working with ACLs, NAT, IPsec VPN, Palo Alto and other firewalls, trying to keep rulesets tight without breaking normal application paths.
- Tend to connect DC and cloud work, from VLAN extensions and IP planning with Infoblox to AWSSecurity Groups and NACLs, keeping addressing and policy aligned across both worlds.
- Prefer having a clear picture of the environment, keep Visio diagrams and IP records close to actual topology so incidents or changes do not start with confusion.
- In data center and virtual network spaces, comfortable moving traffic between physical and virtual using VMware NSX and load balancers, always watching how routing and security interact.
- In incident or go live windows, usually the calm one in the remote session, watching interfaces, routes, and logs while walking teams through small, reversible steps.
- See network engineering as a continuous tuning job, not a one time build, always circling back to monitor, adjust, and simplify configurations so the next person has less to untangle.
- Worked with next-generation firewalls including policy management, NAT, IPSec VPN configuration, and security rule optimization in enterprise environments.
- Supported firewall migrations and remote office connectivity projects involving VPN tunnel setup, routing adjustments, and security policy validation.
- Assisted with centralized firewall management platforms for policy deployment and configuration consistency across branch locations.

Technical Skills

Cisco Routing & Switching: Cisco IOS, Cisco IOS-XE, Cisco 2600 Series, Cisco 2800 Series, Cisco 2900 Series, Cisco 3800 Series, Cisco 7200 Series, Cisco 7600 Series, Cisco Catalyst 2960, Cisco Catalyst 3560, Cisco Catalyst 3750, Cisco Catalyst 3850, Cisco Catalyst 4500, Cisco Catalyst 6500, Cisco Nexus 5K, Cisco Nexus 7K, Cisco Nexus 9K

Data Center & ACI: Cisco ACI Fabric, APIC Controller, Cisco Leaf-Spine Switching, VXLAN EVPN (Cisco ACI)

Routing & VPN: OSPF (Cisco IOS), EIGRP (Cisco IOS), BGP (Cisco IOS), Cisco DMVPN, IPsec VPN (Cisco IOS/ASA), GRE Tunnels (Cisco IOS), MPLS (Cisco IOS)

Layer2 & VLANs: 802.1Q Trunking, STP, RSTP, PVST+, Inter-VLAN Routing (SVI), EtherChannel, LACP, PAgP

Security & Firewalls: Cisco ASA, Cisco PIX, Cisco FWSM, Cisco ASDM, Cisco AnyConnect, Cisco AAA (RADIUS/TACACS+), ACLs (Standard/Extended), NAT, PAT
F5 Load Balancing: F5 BIG-IP LTM, F5 BIG-IP GTM/DNS, F5 TMOS, F5 iApps, F5 SSL Offload, F5 Virtual Servers, F5 Pools & Monitors
Monitoring & Access: SSH, SNMP, Syslog, NTP, Wireshark, Cisco SPAN/RSPAN
Documentation & Tools: Microsoft Visio, Lucidchart, Cisco Packet Tracer, GNS3

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

stellar services inc New York **March 2025 - Present**
Sr. Network Engineer

Responsibilities:

- Day to day handled LAN, WAN, WLAN issues across the enterprise, a lot of Layer 1-3 break-fix, just keeping things stable enough to not wake people at night.
- Cisco heavy environment, set up and tuned routing and switching on Catalyst and Nexus gear, VLANs, trunks, STP/RSTP, EtherChannel, inter-VLAN paths, all the usual bits.
- Pulled packet captures in Wireshark for a nasty inter-VLAN delay issue, chased it through a few hops until we got the latency under control.
- Brought in SolarWinds NPM so we actually had graphs and alerts instead of guessing, downtime alerts became a lot less noisy after that.
- Set up Cisco DNA Center for device onboarding and config pushes, so new switches and APs stopped being a manual copy-paste marathon.
- Ran multi-area OSPF and BGP across the WAN, including redistribution and auth, a fair amount of route-map tinkering to keep paths sane.
- Threw together a Grafana dashboard on top of our routing metrics, OSPF neighbors, BGP sessions, flap counters, all visible in one place.
- Used Ansible playbooks to push OSPF configs to a pile of routers, cut down the usual typo-driven outages.
- Tightened up BGP failover paths and hooked Route 53 DNS failover into it, so WAN site failures switched over without everyone calling the helpdesk.
- Dealt with firewalls and edge security gear, ACLs, NAT, remote-access and site-to-site VPN, plus the usual rule cleanup during migrations.
- Ran periodic scans with Nessus against firewall rulebases and edge devices, found misconfigurations and weird open ports that had slipped through.
- On the cloud side handled AWS security groups and NACLs, trimmed overly open rules and locked down a few chatty subnets.
- Rolled out Palo Alto firewalls for some key edges, tuned security profiles so we were actually catching more bad traffic without breaking normal stuff.
- In the data center took care of VLAN extensions between racks, redundancy links, basic cabling coordination, and kept IP planning from going off the rails.
- Used Infoblox for IP address allocation, cleaned up overlapping scopes and a bunch of random static assignments that kept colliding.
- Pointed Terraform at our data center network resources so common builds became scripts instead of ticket ping-pong.
- Ran a project around VMware NSX for network virtualization, moving a chunk of traffic off physical boxes and into virtual networks.
- Kept applications reachable by tuning load balancer configs and some WAN optimization gear, plus kept the diagrams in Visio roughly matching reality.

Fiserv, Alpharetta, GA **Feb 2024 – Jan 2025**
Network Engineer

Responsibilities:

- Day to day, handled the core and data center network gear, mostly Cisco ASR 9000 and Nexus boxes, doing VLAN moves, IOS upgrades, redundancy tweaks and a bunch of migration cleanup.
- On the Layer 2 and Layer 3 side, set up VLANs, trunks, STP, EtherChannel, IPv4 and IPv6, plus routing with OSPF, BGP, EIGRP so the enterprise links just stayed up.
- Tightened things on the security edge with site to site IPsec VPNs, NAT rules, firewall policy changes and tying gear into enterprise auth, also sat through some long firewall migration and policy mapping sessions.
- Handled high availability routing setups, tuning HSRP pairs and link aggregation using LACP or bundled Ethernet, mostly chasing weird failover behavior until it behaved.
- Ran config and policy changes on enterprise firewalls and load balancers, looked at traffic flows, adjusted rules, fixed breakage and generally kept application traffic both reachable and locked down.
- Tier 3 ticket queue, so I got the odd LAN, WAN, or wireless mess, did packet and flow analysis, kept IP address records sane and updated network diagrams and docs when we changed things.

Amity IT Solutions, Hyderabad, India. **Jan 2020 – July 2023**
Network Engineer

Responsibilities:

- OSPF, EIGRP, a little RIP - set up routing for a bunch of LAN and WAN segments, kept paths sane and traffic not doing strange loops.
- Handled day to day network ops stuff, tickets, weird outages, staring at graphs and logs until the packet loss or flapping link finally showed itself.
- VLANs all over the place, trunk ports, spanning tree tweaks, basic Layer 2 cleanup so different teams had their own segments and things stayed mostly isolated.
- Set up VPN access and authentication for staff and vendors, tuned ACLs so people only reached what they actually needed, plus some remote site access rules.
- Watched interface stats, CPU, error counters on switches and routers using basic monitoring tools, flagged noisy links and slow boxes and pushed for fixes when things kept choking.
- On new site rollouts, brought up switches and routers, checked routing, pings, basic app reachability, then sat on remote sessions during go live to sort out whatever broke first.

Academic Projects

AWS Cloud Network Architecture and Security Implementation

- Designed a secure AWS VPC with public and private subnets across multiple Availability Zones, which took some tweaking to get right.
- Set up Internet Gateway, NAT Gateway, and Security Groups to create a layered security approach, but ran into some issues with route tables initially.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, which cut down deployment time by half and made things a lot smoother.

Enterprise Network Design and Implementation using Cisco Technologies

- Simulated a multi-branch network topology with Cisco Packet Tracer, which involved a lot of trial and error to get the VLAN segmentation right.
- Configured OSPF for internal routing and BGP for WAN connectivity, but had to troubleshoot a few routing loops along the way.

- Used Wireshark for traffic validation and debugging, which helped clear up some confusing issues with packet flow.

Certificates

- **Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP)**

- **Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)**